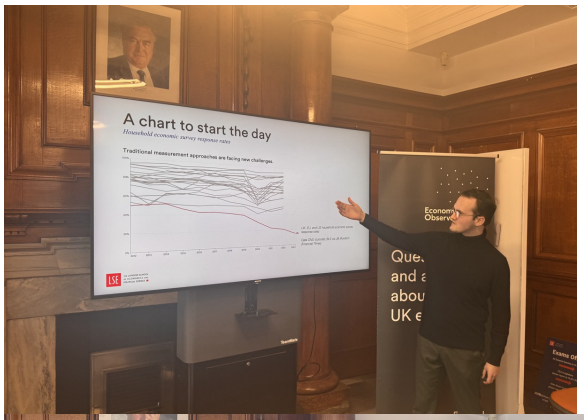
Microdata for policy

In April 2025, the Economics Observatory convened a half-day workshop to explore the production, transformation, and policy application of digital microdata. The event brought together statisticians, data scientists, and economists from across the UK public sector—CMA, ONS, HM Treasury, and LSE—to share ongoing research and foster collaboration among researchers and practitioners.
The workshop aimed to break silos and facilitate structured sharing of innovative uses of microdata, from digital price data to card transactions and employment records, to derive new economic insights.

Session Highlights

- **CMA**. Jakob Schneebacher, Assistant Director of Econometrics at the CMA's Microeconomics Unit, opened the workshop with a presentation on how the agency uses microdata in its research.
- **ONS**: Two sessions introduced new linked datasets projects. *Charlotte Bermingham* introduced health data. *Kyle Jones* presented new employer-employee microdata.
- **Scanner Data for CPI**. Mario Spina (ONS) discussed the methodological and operational challenges in using retail scanner for inflation measurement.
- **Transport**. Jenevieve Treadwell (Leading for London) presented insights from collision microdata in London.
- **HM Treasury**. Laurie McClymont concluded the day with a session on data dissemination through the *Hawkeye* project, an initiative aimed at improving how policy insights are generated and communicated within government.









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